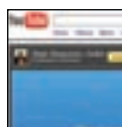




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Winners!

This is the list of winners for the
“Get Smarter” Contest. Winners will
be contacted by Team Digit.



Name	City	Waiver
Arindam Mondal	Kolkata	100%
Sanjeev Chharia	Kolkata	100%
Sunil Kumar Gupta	Mysore	100%
Anuj	Bangalore	50%
Anurag	Kolkata	50%
Sandip Mane	Mumbai	50%
Shivaraj	Mysore	50%
Vaibhav Tyagi	Delhi	50%
Ashish Bansal	Hyderabad	25%
Balaji Cuttackam	Hyderabad	25%
Dhaval Gandhi	Ahmedabad	25%
Imtiyaz Jariwala	Bangalore	25%
Manjunath	Bangalore	25%
Pankaj	Delhi	25%
Punit Shah	Mumbai	25%
S. Vishnu	Hyderabad	25%
Samrat Chakraborty	Kolkata	25%
Ganesh Prabhakar Badhe	Nagpur	25%



Arindam Mondal



Sanjeev Chharia



Sunil Kumar Gupta

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Alpha Geek

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Ever since I made one of my occasional visits to NASA's eclipse site last year, I've been eagerly looking forward to this day. The eclipse was to be only slightly over 90% of total in my area and I knew a photo of it would be nowhere nearly as spectacular as in the totality zone. But it's the first major solar eclipse I'd have a chance to photograph.

I decided to stay up all night rather than catch a couple of hours' sleep and force myself to get up all woozy headed. With some friends whom I've been informally guiding in photography, I went to the house of another friend who's in a good location facing the eastern sky. Dawn came but alas, the morning sky was heavily overcast, with thick fog rolling in too. There wasn't even a faintly luminous spot to indicate where the sun was. We watched TV, the clock

and the darkening sky as the moment of maximum eclipse came and went. Some time later, the weather relented a bit and we began to catch glimpses of the receding eclipse. We started shooting and I took some 60 shots. The clouds were moving so fast that the brightness level changed literally from second to second.

I saw no point in trying to check my exposures in between shots as the next one would need a different level anyway. I went entirely by guesstimate and kept turning the shutter and aperture dials, using exposure values from f/11 at 1/2000 sec with a filter to f/4 at 1/20 sec without a filter.

I was pleasantly

surprised when I later found that more than half of the shots had acceptable exposure, at least acceptable to me, given the circumstances.

Here's the very first shot, taken about 10 minutes after the moment of maximum eclipse:

